

Evidence available to the study

what the bounded study can support and reproduce

Analytical model or proxy

Trace or cycle-level simulation

RTL, synthesis, or physical check

Prototype, silicon, or deployment

Fidelity, cost, scope, and validation vary.

Commitment ladder

what an architectural claim or decision may authorize

Exploratory

Experimental

Implementation

Integration

Irreversible

Consequence and reversibility vary.

Accountable evidence-to-commitment mapping

For each claim or decision, state the required evidence, challenge conditions, and owner.
Authorize only the strongest commitment that the available evidence supports.